side panels which are cut and gathered. Since the fabric drops down, weights can be placed inside these drapes or tapes should be used.

- Trimming, buttons and other accessories can be placed on draped fabrics to check its suitability with the fabric.

In spite of the cost, the method helps one to view the look of the finished garment; hence, correction can be made even before cutting the patterns. It also involves more time and practices.

10.3.3 Commercial Patterns

Commercial patterns were first developed in U.S.A. in 1950's. Later patterns were developed for all age groups of both sexes. Commercial paper is made out of tissue / butter papers for standard body measurements. Generally these patterns are marked for 5 sizes and packed in an envelope. Commercial patterns are produced by companies and sold. It is very popular in foreign countries. The pattern names, number of pieces to be cut, grain, notches, cutting lines, stitching lines, darts and fullness are also marked. On the cover, a picture of the dress is shown. The size, cutting, sewing instructions are also mentioned. The body measurements are mentioned on the cover. This helps one to select the correct size. Dress modifications are given by some companies. The materials required, like buttons and accessories are also printed on the cover.

The major advantages of commercial patterns are good designs, with simple instructions. The pattern will have good fit when compared to other patterns but will need modification in case of irregular body structures. In India commercial patterns are not popular.

10.4 ADVANTAGES OF PAPER PATTERNS

- A correct pattern will result in good fit.
- A pattern prepared on thick paper or card board can be preserved and re-used for a long time.
- Basic patterns can be modified to produce patterns for complicated designs. (Example: the basic bodice front pattern can be modified for a bodice with yoke design).
- A paper pattern can be used to make new patterns of the same design by enlarging or reducing the size of the paper pattern. This is done by a scientific method called "grading".
- It is easier and quicker to cut using a paper pattern than drafting straight on the fabric.
- A paper pattern enables us to cut a garment with a minimum amount fabric. One can find out the most economical way of cutting the fabric by placing the paper pattern on top and trying different ways (Layouts).
- Drafting mistakes can be corrected in the pattern itself.
- Patterns can be modified according to the recent trends in clothing.

10.5 SUMMARY

Patterns are the foundation for dress designing. Patterns can be made by drafting or draping methods. Commercial patterns are available. Each of these methods has their own merits and demerits but can be used for designing all types of dresses irrespective of age and sex. Mastering pattern making will make one to become a good designer.

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